Evgenii Kuzakov - Senior / Team Lead DevOps Engineer

- Building production-ready Kubernetes platforms from scratch — cluster to app delivery in 15–30 min via GitOps & IaC
- 7 yrs DevOps
- 15+ yrs Engineering
- English B2

Professional Summary

- **Platforms as code:** 100% IaC/GitOps on vSphere, Yandex Cloud, AWS, and GCP: Terraform, Terramate, and Ansible provision Talos clusters, Flux reconciles the platform, and Argo CD with ApplicationSets delivers applications from Helm and Kustomize; a new cluster is deployed from Git in 15–30 minutes.
- **Kubernetes as a platform:** A two-tier architecture — a central cluster hosts logging, metrics, the Harbor image registry, and backups (CloudNativePG, Vault, Garage), and workload clusters connect to it over mTLS; networking on Cilium and Gateway API (Envoy Gateway); air-gapped deployment as an option.
- **Access and secrets:** A single IAM on Authentik or Keycloak with OIDC for all services and Kubernetes (Pinniped); 100% of secrets in HashiCorp Vault with automatic delivery via External Secrets; certificates via cert-manager.
- **Secure delivery:** SAST, CVE scanning, Cosign signing, and admission of signed images only via Kyverno; unified Docker BuildKit builds that make maximum use of the cache, GitLab CI/CD, GitHub Actions, and GitVersion-based versioning.
- **Observability:** From infrastructure to business on VictoriaMetrics, Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, and Grafana Alloy — clean, noise-free logs, metrics derived from logs, and business metrics and dashboards.
- **GPU workloads:** NVIDIA GPUs for containers and KubeVirt VMs (VFIO) via GPU Operator, and vLLM.

Employment

- **Project activity — Cloudless Labs, Fluence project (Jan 2026 – Mar 2026) (cloudless.dev)**
  - Developed Terraform-based integration of Authentik with GitHub IdP and OIDC authorization for NetBird, Kubernetes, Argo CD, Homepage, Cargo Registry, and HashiCorp Vault.
  - Tuned Talos, NVIDIA Device Plugin, and GPU Operator for provisioning NVIDIA GPUs across VFIO/KubeVirt environments.
  - Ran GPU workload performance tests across containers, KubeVirt, and native Ubuntu environments to validate deployment models and performance characteristics.

DevOps Engineer — CSSSR (Sep 2025 – Present)

- Implemented the bank's standard for Kubernetes cluster management in an air-gapped environment with **100% IaC/GitOps automation**: a new Talos cluster on vSphere is deployed from Git in **15–30 minutes** (Terraform, Terramate, Flux) with zero manual steps.
- Designed a two-tier cluster architecture: the platform `infra` cluster centralizes logging, metrics, the image registry, and backups, while workload clusters (dev, prod) connect to it over mTLS with no shared passwords.
- Implemented centralized authorization on an in-house IAM (Authentik): OIDC single sign-on for Kubernetes, Vault, Argo CD, Grafana, Harbor, Garage, and Hubble UI, with group-based access.
- Moved **100%** of sensitive data into HashiCorp Vault: all credentials are generated, updated, and injected into services automatically via External Secrets.
- Built centralized logging focused on quality: removed noise (audit volume cut by **~90%**), derived metrics from logs, and forwarded critical events to the bank's SIEM.

- Delivered business observability: metrics and dashboards for BNPL operations, business-level alerts, and a service status feed for the customer.
- Defined all service configuration through GitOps: each environment is described by a single declarative manifest from which Argo CD ApplicationSets generate applications, and CI validates it against a JSON Schema.
- Reduced a release to a branch merge: `chart-updater` automatically bumps service versions in the manifest, and a new version reaches its environment in about **2 minutes**.
- Unified .NET microservice builds with a single Dockerfile-based solution that makes maximum use of the BuildKit cache.
- Set up backups of databases (full backups plus continuous WAL archiving with point-in-time recovery), Vault, and S3 storage.
- Built a secure image supply chain: SAST and Cosign signing in CI, CVE scanning in Harbor, signing of third-party images only when free of critical vulnerabilities (exceptions tracked in Git with an owner and expiry), and a Kyverno policy that admits only signed images to the prod cluster.

Senior DevOps Engineer — HRS International (Jul 2024 – Aug 2025)

- Built a cloud-agnostic platform layout across 3 providers (Yandex, AWS, GCP) — decoupled infra code from config to enable independent release cycles and cut cross-team deployment conflicts.
- Standardized GitOps-first delivery across dev, test, prod, and client-tenant environments through merge-request-driven change management.
- Authored reusable Terraform modules and Terramate stacks, managed drift detection and reconciliation — all infrastructure changes went through Git, zero manual modifications.
- Operated production-grade Yandex MKS clusters and governed cloud services: VPC, DNS, NLB/ALB, Managed PostgreSQL, Object Storage, IAM, KMS.
- Enforced Pod Security Standards, zero-trust network policies, and Vault-based secrets management with automated rotation.

R&D Senior DevOps Engineer — SoftSwiss (Dec 2022 – Aug 2023)

- Reworked SaltStack–Vault integration (Python): achieved **2x** operation speed improvement and **10x** data-access speedup via Redis caching, multi-endpoint access, and Enhanced Key support.
- Researched and implemented a company-wide IAM/SSO model with Keycloak as the central identity source.
- Built a SaltStack Users formula covering user/group management, SSH access, 2FA, and authorized_keys.

Head of DevOps — Latoken (Sep 2022 – Oct 2022) · Contract/Audit

- Conducted a full DevOps infrastructure audit, defined the roadmap, and deployed a **~300k msg/s** logging platform on 5 OpenSearch nodes + 2 Logstash + 2 HAProxy VMs.
- Contributed improvements to the OpenSearch community Ansible playbook: Vagrant-based testing, reduced root requirements, optional UFW/Logstash integration, and Fluent Bit examples.

Senior DevOps — Satel Pro (Oct 2019 – Aug 2022)

- Led DevOps delivery across 5+ development teams, managing 2 dev/test and 5 production Kubernetes clusters.
- Built a fully automated pipeline: Packer images → Terraform/Cloud-init VMs → Kubernetes install → Helmfile services → monitoring & logging — eliminating manual provisioning steps.
- Reworked rollout model with GitLab CI + Helm; implemented release-driven flows (dev → RC → prod) with Vault-secured secrets.
- Optimized Docker builds (multistage, BuildKit, distributed caching, lazy loading) and hardened workloads with requests/limits, probes, PDBs, and read-only filesystems.

Open Projects and Publications

- **Open CI/CD** — production-grade GitLab CI/CD templates reused across multiple projects without modification. Covers Docker BuildKit builds, Helm deployments (ArgoCD/FluxCD/Swarm), SAST, cosign signing, changelogs, and change detection to skip unnecessary jobs.
- **Kubernetes Resource Calculator** — CLI tool for calculating Kubernetes resource requests and limits.
- **Kubernetes Limits Calc Article** — published on Habr.
- **25devops** — DevOps news channel covering Kubernetes, Docker, and DevSecOps.

Full Technology Reference

Area	Stack
Kubernetes & OS	Talos, k0s, Containerd, Cilium, Calico, Gateway API
GitOps & Delivery	FluxCD, Argo CD, Argo Rollouts, Helm, Helmfile, Kustomize
IaC & Config Mgmt	Terraform, Terramate, Ansible, SaltStack, Packer
CI/CD & Builds	GitLab CI/CD, GitHub Actions, Docker BuildKit, Kaniko
Security & IAM	HashiCorp Vault, External Secrets, Keycloak, **Authentik**
Observability	Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, ELK, Logstash, Fluent Bit, Fluentd
Data & Storage	CloudNativePG, Stolon, PoWA, Liquibase, Garage, Nexus, Harbor
Virtualization	VMware vSphere, KubeVirt, VirtualBox
GPU / AI	vLLM, GPU Operator, NVIDIA Device Plugin, Node Feature Discovery
Languages	Bash, Python

Cloud Providers

Provider	Services
Yandex Cloud	IAM, Compute Cloud, VPC, DNS, NLB, ALB, Managed PostgreSQL, Managed Redis, Cloud Logging, Lockbox, Object Storage
AWS	IAM, EC2, EKS, ELB, S3, RDS, Route 53, ACM
GCP	IAM, Compute Engine, Kubernetes Engine, Cloud Load Balancing, GCS, Cloud SQL, Cloud DNS, Certificate Manager
DigitalOcean	Droplets, Networking, Load Balancers, Managed Kubernetes

Education

Omsk State Technical University — “Metrology and Device Manufacturing” faculty

Availability

Remote · Full-time (preferred) · Part-time · Consulting

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Prior Experience

- **IBS Expertise** — Systems Architect / Chief Project Engineer (Oct 2016 – Aug 2019): Designed technical architectures and led pre-sales for large-scale government and enterprise projects.
- **Technoserv** — Systems Architect / Chief Project Engineer (Jun 2014 – Aug 2016): Developed complex infrastructure architectures and led major delivery initiatives, including the Secure City program.
- **Open Technologies Ltd.** — Systems Architect / Chief Technical Project Manager (Aug 2012 – Mar 2014): Managed vendor portfolio development and technical pre-sales for enterprise infrastructure.
- **AMT Group** — Head of Data Processing Centers / Product Manager (Jul 2008 – Jul 2012): Led business development of enterprise infrastructure platforms and strategic vendor partnerships.
- **Open Technologies Ltd.** — Senior Systems Engineer (Feb 2001 – Jun 2008): Delivered HA, storage, SAN, clustering, and DR solutions for large data center projects.
- **Earlier roles** (1994–2000): Systems/Network Administrator at International Trading Bank, Plusinfo, and Laboratory 321 Ltd.